product. This can vary where you live. For example, in Australia, no financial adviser, by law, can receive a built-in commission (and no products offer this) and most charge a fee for investment advice. Whereas in the United States, there are both options available to consumers. The key here is to understand that professionals do not work for free and it's totally okay to ask how any financial professional is remunerated before you engage them. If you are worried about biased opinions, you can always seek a fee-based professional adviser.

### *Robo-advisers*

I'm inclined to say robo-advisers are the new kid on the block but 2008 wasn't a few years ago anymore. Robo-advisers act like artificially intelligent financial advisers. They ask you some questions to gain an idea of what kind of investor you are, and invest on your behalf by setting up an investment portfolio customised to you.

Robo-advisers are good as a set-and-forget option and usually charge a flat fee of around 0.2 to 0.8 per cent per fund, and they can also provide assistance if needed.

The issue with robo-advisers is that if you know what you want to invest in, or you suddenly want to change your investments, you possibly have less control over this decision because your portfolio has been chosen for you. You can't suddenly go buy that GameStop share with a robo-adviser. We're now beginning to see more adoption of AI into investing, but it doesn't replace humans yet.

## Step #7: Buy your shares

Now that you've decided what you want to invest in and with which online broker, it's time to begin.

1. First, create an online profile with the broker of your choice in your country. They usually require some ID so make sure to have that close by.
2. Deposit money into your account. How much should you start with? Generally, $100–500 is a good place for many investors in training.